

Explosions

Explosions are quick releases of lots of energy. They are often loud, bright, and very hot. Fireworks go off when chemicals react together, releasing bursts of light and sound. Volcanoes erupt when pressure builds up underground and is suddenly released, spraying out rock and lava.

Under pressure

Pressure is the name we give to the pushing force of something that is being squashed and contained. When you pump up a bike tyre you squash more air in, increasing the pressure. If you add too much the tyre will burst! Many explosions are caused by pressure building up.



Lava is thrown out of erupting volcanoes.

Volcanoes

When pressure builds up in the liquid rock beneath the Earth's surface, it can explode out in a volcanic eruption. Volcanoes can be so powerful that they turn rock into dust, called ash!